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EAB and the Future of Academic Advising Market

Market Research Report Synthesis

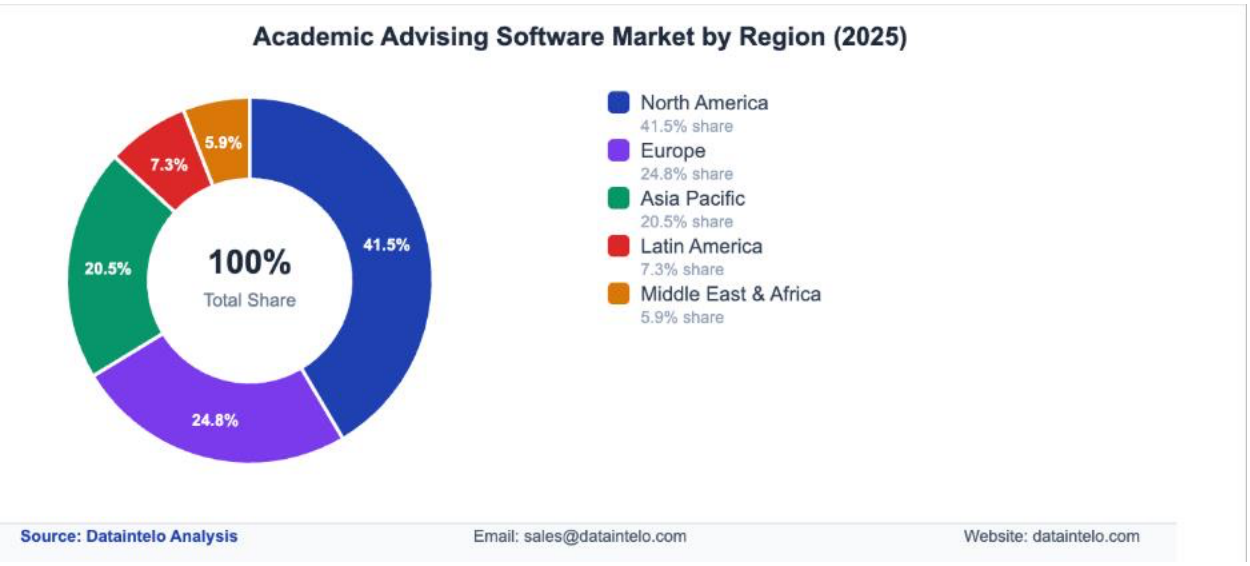
The Organization and its Market Position

EAB, formerly known as the Education Advisory Board, primarily serves K-16 schools and offers products to boost retention, enrollment, and student engagement, while using its research to consult school districts and universities. EAB advertises both services and software that pertain to its mission of building a streamlined and connected educational community. Some of these products include AI Chat Agents, International Student Outreach platforms, and recruitment platforms. However, one of their most popular products is Navigate360, which is a CRM (customer relationship management) platform that targets academic advising space in higher education. Their site is both student- and administrative-facing, offering facilitation for meetings, student profiles, appointment tracking, AI assistance, progress reports, and

connectivity with industry-standard SIS, LMS, email, and calendar services. The primary audience would be academic advisors, who must regularly access a large sample of student data, meet with students regularly, adjust course requirements and course offerings, and discuss personalized routes to satisfy graduation conditions. This platform provides a comprehensive outlook on the tools EAB creates.

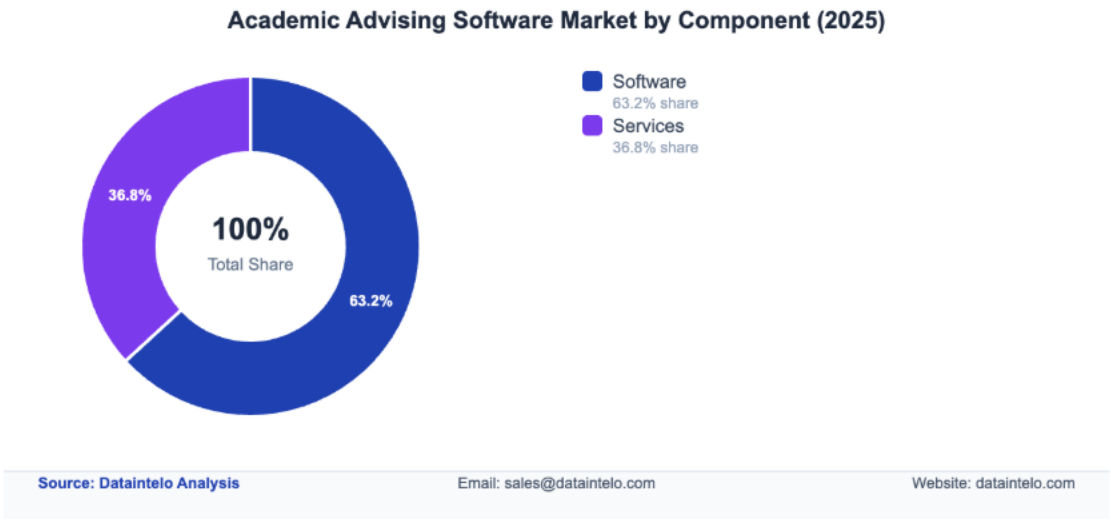
Major Market Findings and Key Themes

Despite growing concerns about the decrease in enrollment nationwide, as degree value is speculated amongst the public, universities continue to advocate for better systems to make their schools more efficient University demand for advising software continues to grow. In 2025, the market was valued at 2.5 billion and "... is projected to reach $5.8 billion by 2034, expanding at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 10.3% during the forecast period from 2026 to 2034," according to Associate Professor at the Indian Institute of Technology, Raksha Sharma. Her research also gives unique perspective into the global scale of this growth, recognizing that the demand for software is developing the most in eastern regions, specifically in Asian Pacific territories, as seen with a 13.1 % CAGR. This data reflects the emerging market of institutions being built and funded overseas.



The Current Market represented above

However, EAB primarily focuses on its North American clientele, which is not just where the greatest demand is, but also where EAB's largest competitors are housed. Also, based on this report's findings, software dominates the total market value, estimated at 1.517 billion. These results are compatible with EAB's Navigate360 platform, as it is a SaaS (Software as a Service) model that follows where money is allocated.



Software Market represented above

Education Consulting is also on the rise, as according to the Business Research Company, findings have reported that "Education Consulting market size has reached to **$4.04 billion in 2025" and is, "**Expected to grow to **$6.34 billion in 2030 at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 9.4"** The proposed reason for this demand is that digital accessibility and production of educational research has given way to more opportunity for advisement.

Future Projections

As accredited universities increase internationally, there will be a larger total market value for the products that EAB and its competitors offer. The demand will mean that there will be a higher sales volume and gives way for more developmental innovation in the field. This innovation will see the most with AI advancements. In tandem with the popularization of AI,

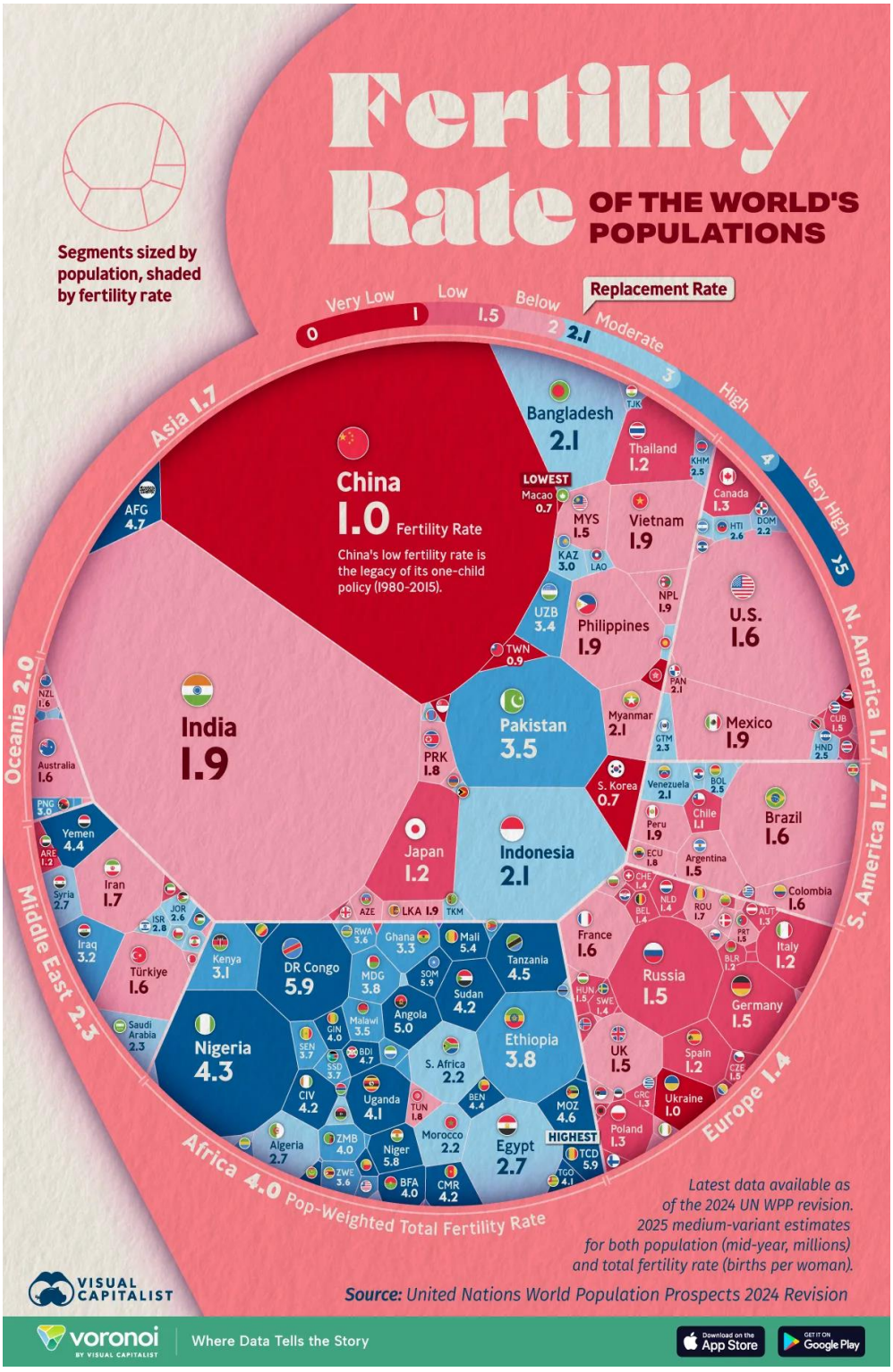
Academic Advising products will continue to be the predominant force in the market, as EAB leans into incorporating these tools into their preexisting online frameworks and systems. A final prediction is along with educational consulting growing, so will the competition amongst organizations. Since educational consulting trends point to there being a steady and almost compound growth in market valuations, companies will be trying to build out their products to meet this demand. EAB already has services that align with this need, so they are in an advantageous position. The time, resources, and money needed to scale up an already established and functional system would require less effort than building a new product altogether.

Critical Analysis

Amidst growing pressures for universities to prove their worth, maintain costs when their budget is significantly decreasing, and provide the most outcomes at minimal cost. Therefore, I agree that universities will be more inclined to adopt AI to sooth skill gaps in labor. There is a growing gap between the skills that are still being taught in universities compared to what is being used in jobs and workplaces. The growing AI trend has changed what skills are needed; there has not been a substantial amount of time for incoming talent at universities to adjust. This time can be detrimental to universities, as it requires resources (money and potential opportunities). EAB has already started to develop AI Chat Agents that can be implemented into websites on the same day as purchase. EAB has already made effective steps and advancements

to cater to this growing trend, making their entry point into innovation more accessible for their organization.

Previously represented data has shown that globally there is an increasing demand for academic advising products and services; however, I do not believe this trend will continue. The number of students has decreased due to the declining birth rates of the upcoming generations. This may mean that the income pool of universities will be limited. In countries where the birth rates do not meet that 2.1 average, the demand for the number of products and tools to keep up with a growing student body will decrease.



Data provided by Visual Capitalist

I also agree that education consulting will maintain a steady revenue stream and continue to grow. Consulting is not only a way for universities to implement current ideas but also allows them to gain insight into using their budgets productively. With some colleges receiving less funding gradually, coupled with the lack of new prospective students due to below-average birth rates, universities may have to take a closer look at how much they are spending. Consulting offers a solution to this issue and may be the primary driver for cost reduction and profitable outcomes.

Implications

Based on the analysis, there are three main implications that can be logically ascertained over the next five to ten years:

1. As higher education expands into eastern countries, an untapped market may develop for EAB Global

At the rate of expansion in college education described specifically in Asian regions, there may be a gap between the opening of colleges and how quickly a domestic company can produce technology to serve that demand. If EAB can be the forerunner in global expansion, by opening an overseas office and tailoring their existing product to the needs of the new institutions, then they have a larger chance of increasing their total market position. EAB has already delved into

marketing for international students. EAB can tailor Navigate360 to service these institutions, which will bring in larger revenue since this is one of, if not the most comprehensive, products they offer.

2. Consulting and "A la Carte" products will remain the most popular in the future as a way to remain cost-effective.

Because universities are trying to save as much money as possible while simultaneously trying to provide quantifiable results and outcomes, they will focus on adding software support or supplemental resources rather than reconfiguring entire SaaS products/ models. Changing an entire platform is costly and overhauling the system is time intensive. Given the saturation in the market already, the differentiation between products would not be enough to make this change; however, consulting and for example AI alternatives will help reduce costs and prioritize productivity of the existing systems, which makes these products more appetizing to customers.

3. When the gaps between technology skills needed and skills being taught starts to subside, universities will be able to create their own solutions and hire internally; therefore, become less dependent on third party companies.

Universities will be inclined to delegate work that they have previously been outsourcing to internal teams. As the gap in skill decreases, universities will be able to solve internal issues

without the need for a third-party company. The implications of this switch would mean that universities will only outsource larger systems. This transition would mean that EAB would not need to focus so much on research and data analysis, since universities will be more capable of handling these processes themselves.

Sources

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